

RIGHT Summer bedfellows

Alliums, bearded irises, campanulas, and verbascons provide perfect companions to a profusion of scented roses in a pink-and-blue-themed summer border. Regular deadheading will prolong the show.

In contemporary schemes, shrub roses are often grown among bulbs, perennials, and other shrubs in a mixed border, but when designing these displays, make sure that neighboring plants do not compete directly for moisture and nutrients. Choose companions that are shallow-rooted, such as the many herbaceous geraniums and pinks (*Dianthus* cultivars), or space plants at a sufficient distance to allow for mulching and feeding around the rose's root zone.

Climbing and rambling roses can be trained on a wall as a colorful backdrop, or on a trellis to form a screen. In addition, they provide a cloak of flowers and foliage when grown on arches and over pergolas, and make focal points on free-standing features such as tripods and pyramids. Large rampant ramblers, such as *R. 'Bobbie James'* and *R. 'Seagull'*, which both can achieve 30ft (10m) or more, will quickly scramble through a tree, offering a profusion of blooms just after most tree blossoms have faded.

Many climbing roses are available as weeping standards too. Tall cultivars of



dense, thorny shrub roses, such as the Rugosa roses, also make decorative structural features. Use them to create large, impenetrable boundary hedges that give privacy and security, or to divide a garden into compartments. Vigorous groundcover roses are ideal for clothing

sunny and inaccessible banks, since most require little regular pruning.

Not all roses will thrive in containers, but smaller patio roses such as *R. KENT* and *R. MAINAUFEUER* are a good choice, while dwarf trailing or spreading cultivars are suitable for hanging baskets.

PRUNING BUSH AND SHRUB ROSES

Modern hybrid tea and floribunda roses, which are commonly grown in gardens, need a hard prune in late winter or early spring to encourage the production of new flowering shoots. Shrub roses require a more gentle pruning regime. Roses also benefit from a light prune in fall to prevent long stems from blowing in the wind and rocking the plant, which may result in root damage. Pruning in a

methodical way has other horticultural advantages, helping to control attacks from fungal diseases such as blackspot, to which roses are particularly susceptible, by removing infected wood. Before pruning, use a household disinfectant to clean your shears, and apply it again before tackling each new plant to prevent the spread of disease. Also make sure your shears are sharp, as clean cuts heal more quickly.



Pruning floribunda roses

Also known as cluster-flowered roses, floribundas produce flushes of blooms through summer and early fall. In early spring, remove dead, diseased, and crossing stems. Prune the other stems to outward-facing buds 8–12in (20–30cm) from the ground using sloping cuts. Aim to leave a framework of 8 to 10 strong, healthy stems.



Pruning hybrid tea roses

These are large-flowered roses, and include some varieties that repeat bloom, although they produce just one flower per stem. In late winter or early spring, cut the oldest stems to the ground, and shorten the remainder to 6in (15cm) from the base. Leave three to five strong young stems after pruning and angle cuts to allow water to drain off the buds.



Pruning shrub and species roses

These usually flower once on wood made in previous years, so prune lightly in early spring. Remove dead, damaged, or diseased wood, and thin out congested growth to improve air flow. Also cut some of the oldest stems to the ground. Cut main stems back by a quarter and slightly reduce side shoots by an inch or two.